

Cover Letter: Data Science Role – Stellantis Financial Services US

To the Data Science Hiring Committee at Stellantis Financial Services US,

One of my deepest convictions is that my vocation should enable me to engage with work that has a transformative, positive influence on the world. My journey into statistics began with a prevailing thought: “*Wow, data is so powerful.*” Since then, my driving mission has been to use statistical methods to empower people with insights for good stewardship, especially within the realm of finance and mobility. I am applying for the Data Science role because Stellantis Financial Services’ commitment to providing accessible, innovative financial solutions perfectly aligns with my desire to build mathematical methods for practical impact. I want to deploy machine learning and analytic solutions to help business leaders uncover patterns in heterogeneous data that directly enhance the customer journey and optimize financial operations.

My appetite for understanding and deriving models to map complex phenomena was cemented during the incredibly formative summer of 2022. I had the privilege of studying at the Duke and North Carolina State University Summer Institute for Biostatistics (SIBS). There, I was exposed to the complexities of messy, real-world data, navigating missing values, Bayesian modeling, and predictive analysis. The experience culminated in a thrilling hackathon where I partnered with peers to build a logistic regression model predicting critical outcomes from raw datasets. Exploring and modeling that messy data was the catalyst that convinced me to hang up my NCAA baseball spikes and commit my high-bandwidth work ethic fully to graduate studies in statistics.

Currently, as a Statistical Science PhD student at Baylor University, I continue to translate complex data into actionable insights. Through my role as a Graduate Assistant, I have consulted for interdisciplinary research teams across various domains. This consultative experience directly translates to your need for a data scientist who can work cross-functionally alongside engineers, analysts, and business stakeholders, translating complex business problems into actionable data products and presenting findings in easy-to-understand terms. Technically, I am deeply equipped to tackle your business problems. I leverage Python and R to deploy a wide array of models—from deep learning (PyTorch/TensorFlow) and ensemble models (XGBoost) to Bayesian methods and predictive analytics.

In this age of information, the financial and mobility sectors are crying out for better tools to assist in decision-making. I am hungry to join Stellantis Financial Services US to create parsimonious, accurate, and efficient models that augment business capabilities and personalize customer interactions. Given my background of managing maximum credit hours, faculty-mentored research, and interdisciplinary consulting—all while having previously balanced a demanding varsity athletic schedule—I am confident in my ability to manage a varied workload of projects with multiple priorities in a dynamic enterprise environment.

Thank you for your time and consideration. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my technical toolkit and passion for data-driven stewardship make me a strong fit for your team.

Sincerely,

Carson Slater

PhD Student, Statistical Science
Baylor University